

How the beef carcass grade gets decided

An executive overview of the scorecard behind Calibra's beef carcass grading — for leadership and grading-desk stakeholders.

Prepared 14 Sep 2026 · **Updated** 29 Sep 2026

Scope BG1021 (steer) — lamb & goat remain manual · **Mode** shadow (advisory)

6

visual attributes scored
per carcass

0–18

Verdict 1 point range

5

carcass weight tiers
(200–300kg ceiling)

7

possible outcomes (6
sellable + Condemned)

How a carcass is graded

Every BG1021 carcass runs through the same scorecard, worked from the reference grading sheet. A wide set of conditions can decide the outcome outright before any score is tallied — see **Automatic overrides** below. Otherwise, settlement weight is required to finalize every grade, not just to break ties.

- 01** QA scores six visual attributes — **Dentition, Fat Cover, Bruising/Blemishes, Fat Colour, Meat Colour, Muscle Conformation** — and the points sum to `verdict1` .
- 02** `verdict1` is checked against every grade's scoring band. The bands **overlap by design** — FAQ and Standard, for instance, now share an identical 10–16 band — so one score routinely lands inside more than one grade at once.
- 03** Settlement weight is now **required to finalize** any grade — even when only one band fits. Until the carcass is weighed, the system offers that grade only as a provisional suggestion, flagged `awaiting weight` ; QA can still grade manually in the meantime.
- 04** Once weight is known, it's banded into five tiers and can only ever pull the grade **down, never up**: `verdict2 = verdict1 + weight_tier` . If more than one band fit, weight decides between them; if only one band fit, weight can still downgrade it further.
- 05** If settlement weight falls outside every defined band (heavier than the Premium ceiling), or the grade still can't be resolved to one outcome even with weight applied, the carcass is **flagged for QA review** rather than guessed at.
- 06** The system records its own suggestion alongside whatever QA finally saves — it never overwrites their call. That's **shadow mode**, on the last page.

AUTOMATIC OVERRIDES

These conditions decide the outcome outright, regardless of score. When more than one applies at once, the **worst outcome wins** — Condemned beats Poor C beats Commercial.

- **Condemned** ← Bruising = Condemned — not a sellable grade; recorded on the settlement sheet, not scored on this matrix at all.

- **Poor C** ← Bruising = Detained; Bruising = Severe; Muscle Conformation = Poorly conformed

- **Commercial** ← Fat Cover = None; Fat Cover = Inadequate; Fat Colour = Deep yellow; Bruising = Mild

Only **Bruising = No bruises** avoids an override outright — every other bruising value now decides the grade on its own, independent of the other five attributes.

Points by attribute

What QA actually selects for each of the six attributes, and the points each option carries toward Verdict 1.

DENTITION

Full mouth	1
3 pairs	2
2 pairs	3
1 pair	3
Milk teeth	3

FAT COVER

Marbling (heavy, well-marbled)	4
Good (3–10mm+, even)	3
Fair (2–7mm)	2
Inadequate †	1
None †	0

† Inadequate/None also trigger an automatic override to Commercial — see previous page.

FAT COLOUR

Cream white	3
Light yellow	2
Deep yellow †	1

† Deep yellow also triggers an automatic override to Commercial.

MEAT COLOUR

Bright red	2
Dark	1

BRUISING / BLEMISHES

No bruises	3
Mild bruises †	2
Severe bruises †	1
Detained †	1
Condemned †	0

† Every value except No bruises triggers an automatic override — see previous page.

MUSCLE CONFORMATION

Well finished (thick flesh)	3
Fairly conformed	2
Poorly conformed †	1

† Poorly conformed also triggers an automatic override to Poor C.

Grade bands

Where each grade's Verdict 1 range sits, and the weight tier it needs to finalize.

GRADE	VERDICT 1 BAND	WEIGHT TIER REQUIRED
Premium	17–18	Tier 5 — 200–300kg
High Grade	16–17	Tier 4 — 170–199.9kg
FAQ	10–16	Tier 3 — 150–169.9kg
Standard	10–16	Tier 2 — 120–149.9kg
Commercial	8–14	Tier 1 — below 120kg
Poor C	0–7	No weight floor of its own
Condemned	—	Automatic override only (Bruising = Condemned); not scored

FAQ and Standard now share an identical Verdict 1 band (10–16) — weight is what tells them apart. Above 300kg, weight falls outside every band — the carcass is flagged for QA review, not assumed Premium.

Weight bands

Five bands, drawn from the reference sheet's weight table. Weight can only ever pull a grade down from what the visual score alone suggests — never up — and is required to finalize every grade, not just to break ties.

TIER 1

Commercial
below 120kg

TIER 2

Standard
120–149.9kg

TIER 3

FAQ
150–169.9kg

TIER 4

High Grade
170–199.9kg

TIER 5

Premium
200–300kg

SHADOW MODE

The scorecard computes `verdict1 / verdict2 / auto_classification` for every carcass and stores it alongside whatever grade QA actually saves — it suggests, never decides. Each saved row is tagged **auto** or **manual** depending on whether QA's own choice matched the suggestion.

A `flagged` marker covers cases the system couldn't confidently resolve — a tie weight didn't settle, or a weight outside the expected range. An `awaiting weight` marker shows suggestions still waiting on the carcass being weighed. Automatic overrides (above) bypass scoring entirely and are never flagged.

That agreement trail is what tells us when it's safe to let the system decide on its own — it isn't there yet.

Live for **BG1021 steer carcasses only**. Lamb and goat keep their existing manual grading, unchanged.

Prepared from the QA grading system · internal use

Updated 29 Sep 2026 (originally prepared 14 Sep 2026) — see **Automatic overrides**, **Grade bands** and **Points by attribute** for what's changed since the first version.

Accent ink echoes the violet, food-safe dye used on physical grade stamps.